

# Script & Soundbite Archives — Master Evidence Packet (Block Format)

This packet collects recurring political phrases such as “Now is not the time,” “We have no choice,” and “This is not a blank check.” Each entry shows the quote in full, along with who said it, when, and in what context.

## SSA-1 — “Now Is Not the Time” Script

**Date:** 2017-10-04

**Speaker:** Chuck Schumer (Senate)

**Context:** Gun reform debate after the Las Vegas shooting

**Action:** Floor speech

**Source:** govinfo.gov

**Quote:**

“We have heard it over and over again: Now is not the time to talk about gun safety because it would politicize the tragedy.”

**Date:** 2021-02-25

**Speaker:** Lindsey Graham (Senate)

**Context:** Minimum wage increase to \$15/hour

**Action:** Budget hearing

**Source:** congress.gov

**Quote:**

“Right now is not the time, in my view... at a time of restaurants and hotels barely hanging on...”

**Date:** 2014-01-06

**Speaker:** Jay Carney (White House)

**Context:** Emergency unemployment insurance

**Action:** Press briefing

**Source:** obamawhitehouse.gov

**Quote:**

“Now is not the time to start cutting off emergency unemployment benefits.”

**Date:** 2023-03-08

**Speaker:** Mitch McConnell (Senate)

**Context:** District of Columbia criminal code reform

**Action:** Floor speech

**Source:** govinfo.gov

**Quote:**

“The DC Council thought that now was an appropriate time to rewrite the Criminal Code...”

**Date:** 2015-08-25

**Speaker:** Barack Obama (White House)

**Context:** Clean energy and climate policy

**Action:** Speech

**Source:** obamawhitehouse.gov

**Quote:**

“Now is not the time to pull back on those investments in clean energy.”

**Date:** 2007-01-31

**Speaker:** George W. Bush (White House)

**Context:** Tax policy and economic recovery

**Action:** Economic speech

**Source:** georgewbush-whitehouse.archives.gov

**Quote:**

“Now is not the time for the federal government to be raising taxes on the American people.”

**Date:** 2023-05-24

**Speaker:** Kevin McCarthy (House)

**Context:** Debt ceiling negotiations

**Action:** Press conference

**Source:** speaker.gov

**Quote:**

“Now is not the time to be talking about tax hikes.”

## **SSA-2 — “We Have No Choice” Script**

**Date:** 2001-09-14

**Speaker:** Tom Lantos (House)

**Context:** Authorization for Use of Military Force after 9/11

**Action:** Floor speech

**Source:** congress.gov

**Quote:**

“We have no choice but to respond to these acts with ‘all necessary and appropriate force.’”

**Date:** 2003-02-11

**Speaker:** Ari Fleischer (White House)

**Context:** Selling the case for invading Iraq

**Action:** Press briefing

**Source:** georgewbush-whitehouse.archives.gov

**Quote:**

“We have no choice but to share that information on Iraq WMDs and hope that people listen.”

**Date:** 2008-09-29

**Speaker:** John Boehner (House)

**Context:** TARP financial bailout

**Action:** Floor speech

**Source:** congress.gov

**Quote:**

“We have no choice but to act on the bailout to protect the American economy.”

**Date:** 2020-03-18

**Speaker:** Donald Trump (White House)

**Context:** Border closures during the COVID-19 pandemic

**Action:** Press briefing

**Source:** trumpwhitehouse.archives.gov

**Quote:**

“We have no choice... we will never hesitate to take any necessary steps [closing borders].”

**Date:** 2023-05-31

**Speaker:** Kevin McCarthy (House)

**Context:** Debt ceiling deal and spending cuts

**Action:** Press conference

**Source:** speaker.gov

**Quote:**

“We have no choice but to cut spending... we cannot continue to borrow money from China.”

## **SSA-3 — “It’s Too Expensive” Script**

**Date:** 2020-02-12

**Speaker:** Steven Mnuchin (Senate)

**Context:** Defending the cost of the 2017 tax cuts

**Action:** Senate Finance hearing

**Source:** finance.senate.gov

**Quote:**

“We believe that the tax cuts will pay for themselves over a 10-year period of time.”

**Date:** 2017-12-19

**Speaker:** Mike Enzi (Senate)

**Context:** Arguing that the 2017 tax cuts will generate revenue

**Action:** Floor vote (YEA)

**Source:** congress.gov

**Quote:**

“Better tax policy will boost the value of everything... and this will mean more revenue.”

**Date:** 2017-10-04

**Speaker:** Chuck Schumer (Senate)

**Context:** Criticizing the cost of the same tax package

**Action:** Floor speech (NAY)

**Source:** govinfo.gov

**Quote:**

“Republicans are proposing to pay for their giant tax cut to the rich by gutting Medicare and Medicaid.”

**Date:** 2021-05-28

**Speaker:** Rand Paul (Senate)

**Context:** Warning about additional federal borrowing

**Action:** Floor speech (NAY)

**Source:** govinfo.gov

**Quote:**

“Borrow as much as you can... it doesn’t really seem to make a lot of sense.”

## **SSA-4 — “For the Safety of the American People” Script**

**Date:** 2020-03-20

**Speaker:** Donald Trump (White House)

**Context:** COVID emergency measures and travel restrictions

**Action:** Press briefing

**Source:** [trumpwhitehouse.archives.gov](https://trumpwhitehouse.archives.gov)

**Quote:**

"I will never hesitate to take any necessary steps to protect the lives, health, and safety of the American people."

**Date:** 2023-07-12

**Speaker:** Matt Olsen (House)

**Context:** Defending FISA 702 surveillance authorities

**Action:** House oversight hearing

**Source:** [congress.gov](https://congress.gov)

**Quote:**

"Restoring and maintaining trust in the FISA process is essential for the safety of the American people."

**Date:** 2021-03-18

**Speaker:** Bill Posey (House)

**Context:** Arguing for tougher border and immigration enforcement

**Action:** Floor remarks

**Source:** [govinfo.gov](https://govinfo.gov)

**Quote:**

"Restoring our border is essential to putting the safety and security of Americans first."

**Date:** 2001-09-14

**Speaker:** Tom Lantos (House)

**Context:** Supporting a strong response following 9/11

**Action:** Floor speech

**Source:** congress.gov

**Quote:**

“The goal of the terrorist is to instill fear... but the safety of the American people will not have that success.”

## **SSA-5 — “This Is Not a Blank Check” / “We Must Support Our Allies”**

**Date:** 2022-10-23

**Speaker:** Nancy Pelosi (House)

**Context:** Defending ongoing Ukraine assistance

**Action:** Television interview

**Source:** pelosi.house.gov

**Quote:**

“We’ve never said that anybody had a blank check... but be wary of them walking away from our support for democracy.”

**Date:** 2023-10-18

**Speaker:** Kevin McCarthy (House)

**Context:** Questioning further Ukraine funding

**Action:** Press conference

**Source:** speaker.gov

**Quote:**

“I’m not going to give a blank check to anything.”

**Date:** 2024-04-16

**Speaker:** Jeanne Shaheen (Senate)

**Context:** Backing a national security supplemental bill

**Action:** Senate floor speech

**Source:** shaheen.senate.gov

**Quote:**

“Support for Ukraine and our allies isn’t a blank check; it’s not charity.”

**Date:** 2023-11-08

**Speaker:** Michael McCaul (House)

**Context:** Supporting military aid to Israel

**Action:** Committee hearing

**Source:** congress.gov

**Quote:**

“It is imperative that we continue to project strength and stand united with Israel.”

**Date:** 2023-11-08

**Speaker:** Tim Burchett (House)

**Context:** Opposing an Israel supplemental on cost grounds

**Action:** Press statement

**Source:** burchett.house.gov

**Quote:**

“I would have liked to vote for this bill, but it contains billions...”

**Date:** 2025-06-10

**Speaker:** Rosa DeLauro (House)

**Context:** Arguing for continued foreign aid commitments

**Action:** Committee statement

**Source:** democrats-appropriations.house.gov

**Quote:**

“Now is not the time to retreat from our alliances even further.”

## Summary



Across these examples, the same short phrases appear repeatedly in different debates. These scripts help frame complex policy choices in simple emotional terms and can make certain options seem off-limits before they are even discussed. Viewing them together reveals how scripted language shapes the public conversation about war, spending, safety, and responsibility.